



‘THE TALK’

As school year unfolds, Black and brown parents revisit lessons of systemic racism with their children

By Darcel Rockett | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As students settle into the school year and “new normal,” parents take the journey with them — lending support and guidance as the back-to-school season unfolds amid the surprises and challenges everyday school interactions bring. Sometimes navigating the school year feels like a “Choose Your Own Adventure” book, where one decision could quickly spiral into devastating results and alter the course of a young person’s life.

One thing, however, remains constant: “the talk.”

It’s the conversation Black and brown parents have been having for generations with their children on how systemic racism and racial profiling can turn deadly in an instant. It’s a message they share with their children to equip them with the necessary knowledge to protect themselves from being hurt or killed during everyday activities that turn into racialized encounters with police and others.

Joy Sapp, a Chatham native, remembers having “the talk” when her eldest, Robert Wise III, 17, was 9 and her youngest, Elliott Donaldson Jr., 13, was 5. Parents like Sapp are revisiting the talk and now including friends — all to make sure their children stay safe, recognize pervasive biases, de-escalate scenarios they may encounter and remove themselves from situations that run counter to their well-being.

The conversations — online and in real life — have been particularly significant in recent months after the death of Nolan Wells, the Black teen who traveled to an uninhabited island off of Mississippi’s Gulf Coast on a July Fourth boat trip with a group of friends, all of whom were white. He did not return to the mainland with his friends; instead, his body was found two days later off the

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Langston Golden, 16, walks to Kenwood Academy High School in Hyde Park on Aug. 25. Golden recently had an interaction with law enforcement while at a South Side bus stop on his way home from work. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

ELECTION 2026 SENATE

GOP on defense in red states

Move to pull cash from NC, pour spending into Kansas reveals dire map for party

By Joey Cappelletti and Thomas Beaumont
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Senate Republicans’ top campaign spending organization is pulling back in North Carolina and pouring money into Kansas, a striking shift that shows how the party’s plan to keep its majority has turned into an increasingly defensive fight ahead of November’s midterms.

The decision by the Senate Leadership Fund, a super PAC aligned with top Senate Republicans, was disclosed Friday by four people with direct knowledge of the situation who insisted on anonymity to discuss internal strategy.

Ad cancellations are a common, and very telling, move down the stretch of campaigns, as they reveal where national operatives see their best path to a majority.

The shifting resources signal a lack of confidence that Michael Whatley, a former Republican National Committee chairman who was President Donald Trump’s choice to run for Senate in North Carolina, can beat Democratic former Gov. Roy Cooper.

Super PACs aligned with Trump also do not have any future reservations for airtime in the North Carolina Senate race.

“I am worried about (Whatley),” Trump told reporters Friday as he was departing for a campaign rally in Alabama. “I hope he wins.”

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■ Even though House districts were redrawn in Texas and Florida to make them easier to win, Republicans are weighed down by the public’s dissatisfaction with President Donald Trump. **Nation & World, Page B5**

Out of public eye for months, Kane County sheriff retires

By Molly Morrow and Rebecca Johnson
AURORA BEACON-NEWS

The Kane County sheriff, who has been missing from the public eye for about six months, announced Friday he’s stepping down to “focus on his health and to ensure continuity of leadership.”

Sheriff Ron Hain will retire Nov. 1, ending his 30-year career in law enforcement, according to a news release from the Kane County sheriff’s office and state’s attorney’s office. He declined interviews, asking the public to “respect his privacy as he focuses on his health,” but said in a statement that “serving the people of Kane County has been the honor of my life.”

“I’m proud of what we built together and prouder still of the men and women of this office who show up for this community every single day,” he said.

Hain hasn’t made a public appearance since at least the spring. The Tribune had submitted Freedom of Information requests about Hain’s absence Wednesday to the sheriff’s office.

Rumors of the reason behind Hain’s absence have swirled over the past year.



Hain

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AL DIVISION SERIES GAME 1 WHITE SOX AT GUARDIANS

When: Noon **Where:** Progressive Field, Cleveland **TV:** TBS, truTV and HBO Max **Radio:** WMVP-AM1000
In Sports: Can the White Sox can keep succeeding in the postseason without a conventional pitching rotation?

From cellar to hot seller

Stores scramble to keep up with demand for Sox gear

By Jane Miller
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

At downtown sports apparel shop Chicago Sports & Novelty, manager Loretta Rizzo laid out a freshly stocked stack of Munetaka Murakami jerseys.

“We’ve sold out of these three times,” she said, pointing to the pile of black and white fabric with the White Sox first baseman’s name spelled out in Japanese characters.

Since the wild-card round started, Munetaka Murakami has had the fourth-best-selling jersey in all of baseball, and the top three selling jerseys for the White Sox, according to sports merchandise company Fanatics. But it’s not just Murakami gear that fans are snatching up. Sales of White Sox merchandise across the board are up two times this week compared with last week.

With the team headed to the American League Division Series this weekend, stores across Chicago are experiencing an unprecedented demand for White Sox merchandise.

“They just won less than 24 hours ago,”



Colleen Doyle, a lifelong White Sox fan armed with tickets to Monday’s game in Cleveland, shops on Friday for a new shirt at Grandstand, a sports merchandise store in the South Side’s Bridgeport neighborhood. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Jason Caref, owner of Clark Street Sports, said on Thursday, referring to the team’s win over the Houston Astros. “There were a bunch of online sales overnight.”

“I’m expecting a big weekend as they get into the next round,” he added.

At sports apparel store Grandstand, located just down the street from Rate Field, “anything with the Sox logo currently is flying off the shelf,” owner Stephanie Ganal said.

Grandstand is primarily known for its White Sox gear, but usually in October, the clothing on display is for the Bears.

“When we are into Bear season, and our sales floor is still primarily White Sox, you know the team is doing it well,” Ganal said with a laugh.

Inside Grandstand, amid rows of black and white hats, jerseys, lunchboxes and

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